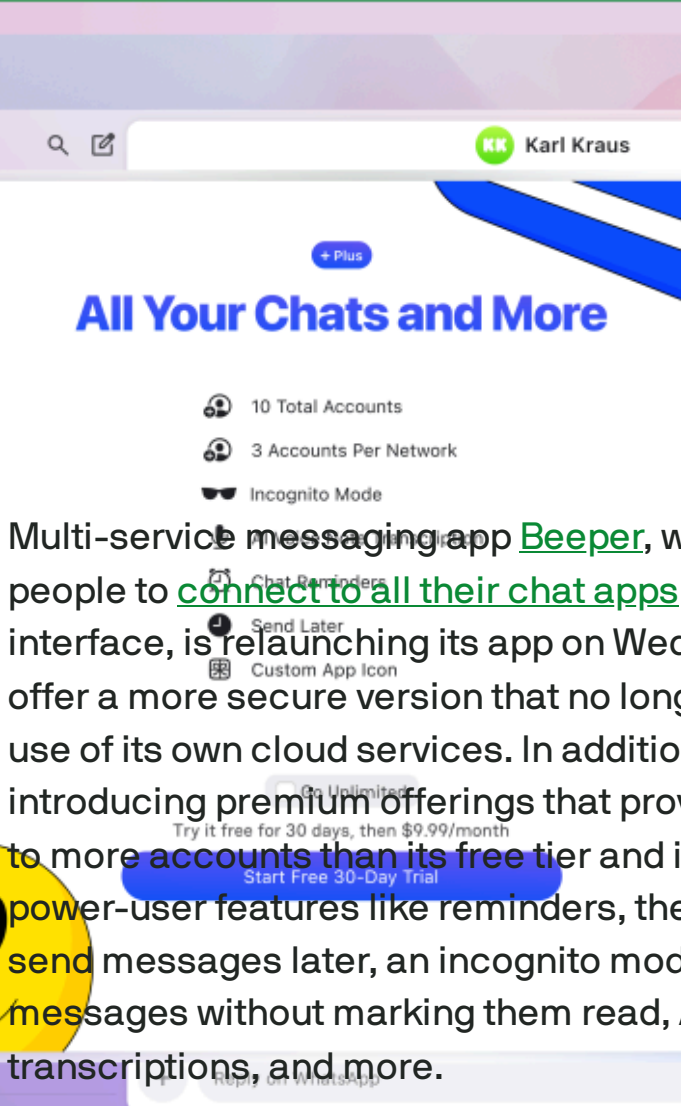


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SOCIAL



Beeper's all-in-one
messaging app
relaunches with an on-
device model and
premium upgrades



Sarah Perez — 3:00 PM PDT · July 16, 2025

Multi-service messaging app [Beeper](#), which allows people to [connect to all their chat apps](#) from one interface, is relaunching its app on Wednesday to offer a more secure version that no longer requires use of its own cloud services. In addition, Beeper is introducing premium offerings that provide access to more accounts than its free tier and include power-user features like reminders, the ability to send messages later, an incognito mode to read messages without marking them read, AI voice note transcriptions, and more.

Now owned by WordPress.com maker [Automattic](#), which bought Beeper for [\\$125 million](#) in 2024, the app has almost entirely integrated with competitor Texts.com, which Automattic [also acquired the year prior for \\$50 million](#).

With a combined 30-person team (including contractors) and now operating under the Beeper brand, the messaging app supports WhatsApp, Instagram, Messenger, X, Telegram, Signal, Matrix, Slack, Google Chat, Discord, LinkedIn, and Google Messages (SMS/RCS). On Mac computers only, Beeper can also connect users with their iMessage chats, though [Apple has shut down this access](#) in prior versions.

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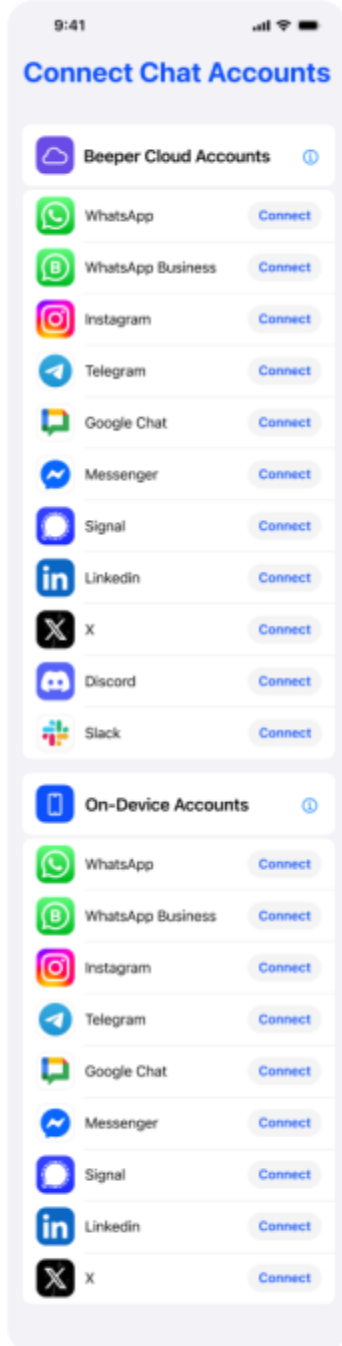


IMAGE CREDITS: AUTOMATTIC/BEEPER

The overall goal, according to Automattic, is to simplify the problem of having too many messaging apps to keep up with, while also keeping those chats secure.

The app previously first connected with Beeper Cloud before communicating with the messaging network, said Beeper CEO Kishan Bagaria. While that system remains the default, users will now have the option of switching to Beeper on device, which will see the app connecting directly to the messaging network and skipping the middleman.

“That ensures that end-to-end encryption is preserved and your privacy is as good as the official

- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines
- The best dating apps aren't even dating apps

app,” Bagaria told TechCrunch in an interview ahead of the app’s relaunch. Whether the companies involved will appreciate having their own apps bypassed, however, remains to be seen.

“We have good relationships with some of these companies, and some of them are OK with this,” Bagaria said. “Others, we have not really heard from much.”

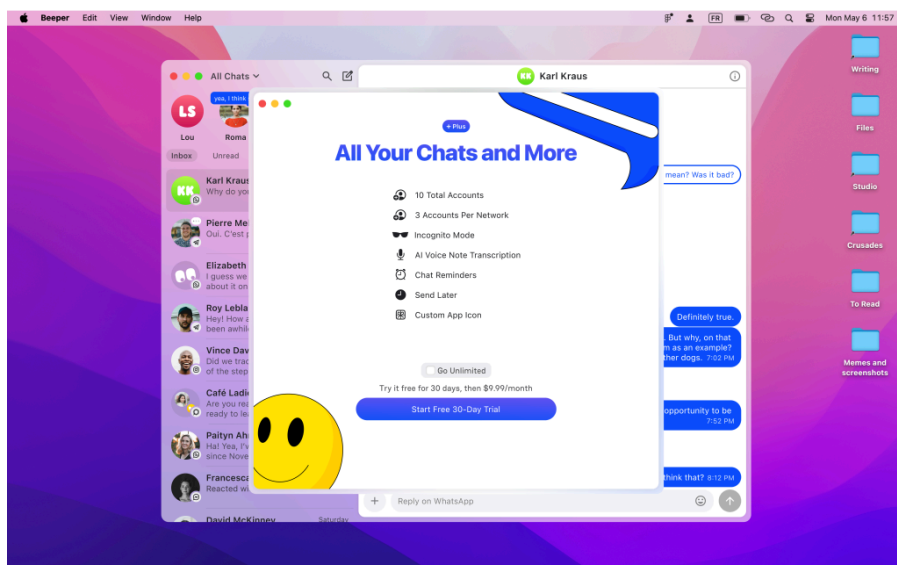


IMAGE CREDITS: AUTOMATTIC/BEEPER

To stave off any potential shutdowns by messaging network providers, Beeper aims to support the business models of the first-party apps whenever possible. For example, if Telegram is showing ads, those ads will be shown in Beeper, too.

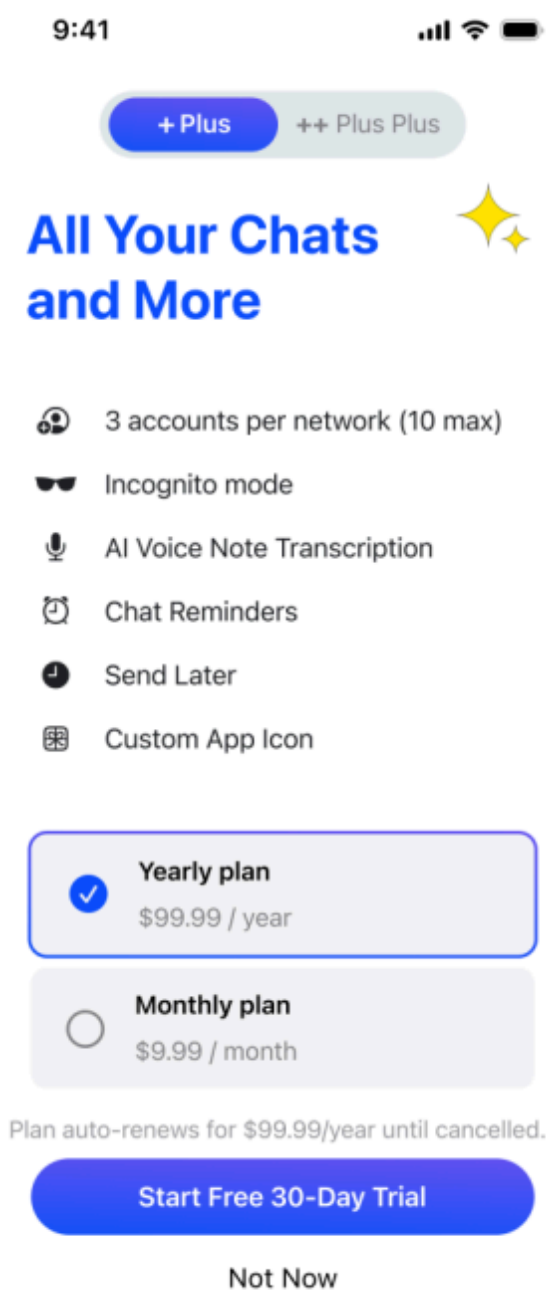
In addition, EU regulations requiring that [messaging platforms be interoperable](#) could put pressure on messaging app providers to leave a solution like Beeper’s alone.

Alongside the relaunch, there will now be an option to upgrade to a new \$9.99 per month premium plan, Beeper Plus, which allows users to connect with 10 messaging services instead of just the five that free users have access to.

In addition, Plus subscribers have the option to schedule messages to send later, can set reminders to follow up on chats, read messages in

Incognito mode so they don't feel pressured to respond immediately, access multiple accounts per network, view AI voice note transcriptions (processed via OpenAI's Whisper model with user consent), and swap out their app icon for a custom version.

An even higher tier, Beeper Plus Plus, which starts at \$49.99 per month, offers access to unlimited accounts and is designed with the needs of businesses or social media managers in mind. (Annual subscriptions are also available at a discounted price of \$99.99 per year for Beeper Plus and \$499 per year for Beeper Plus Plus.)

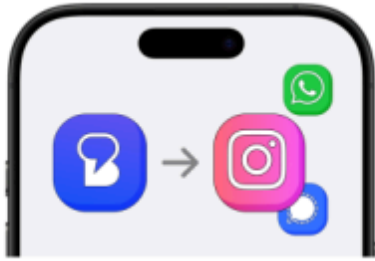


After Automattic acquired Beeper, the company combined its team with Texts.com to develop a new product that offered the best of both services. With Wednesday's relaunch, those apps are now 99% integrated, Bagaria said, as only a few smaller features remain to be ported over.

Eventually, [Automattic's latest acquisition, the personal CRM Clay](#), which may later be rebranded, will also be integrated with Beeper, though it will remain a stand-alone app.

"It will mostly be built on top of the Beeper platform — it'll stay complimentary," Bagaria said. "Clay is an amazing app [as it] works today. Then, with Beeper, it can just ingest more interactions and data, which will make it like 2x to 10x better. Once that is done, I'm sure Clay can be a very powerful product."

Beeper today has millions of registered users, including those from Texts.com. A small portion of those who are still using Texts.com are now being offered the option to migrate to Beeper, since it has added the on-device technology, which they prefer.

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Beeper Cloud Accounts

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IMAGE CREDITS: AUTOMATTIC/BEEPER

Bagaria said there may still be some remaining issues around reliability when moving to the on-device model, but those are being worked out as edge cases pop up. At some later point, Beeper Cloud will be deprecated once the company is sure the on-device model is capable of being everyone's daily driver.

Further down the road, Beeper aims to make its data available to other companies, with user permission and controls to protect privacy. For instance, an [MCP](#) (model context protocol) Beeper one day could let users connect to chat apps via Claude or

ChatGPT to ask it things like “summarize all my important messages from this evening.”

Those developments will take some time, as Bagaria says he’s also a “very privacy-conscious user,” and would want a solution that’s very transparent about what data is accessed and when, and one that allows users to even manually say yes or no to data requests, perhaps.

“We also don’t want to have server farms where we have models trained on your data. That’s a complete no-no,” he said.

Topics: [Apps](#) [Automattic](#) [Beeper](#) [messaging](#)

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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor |

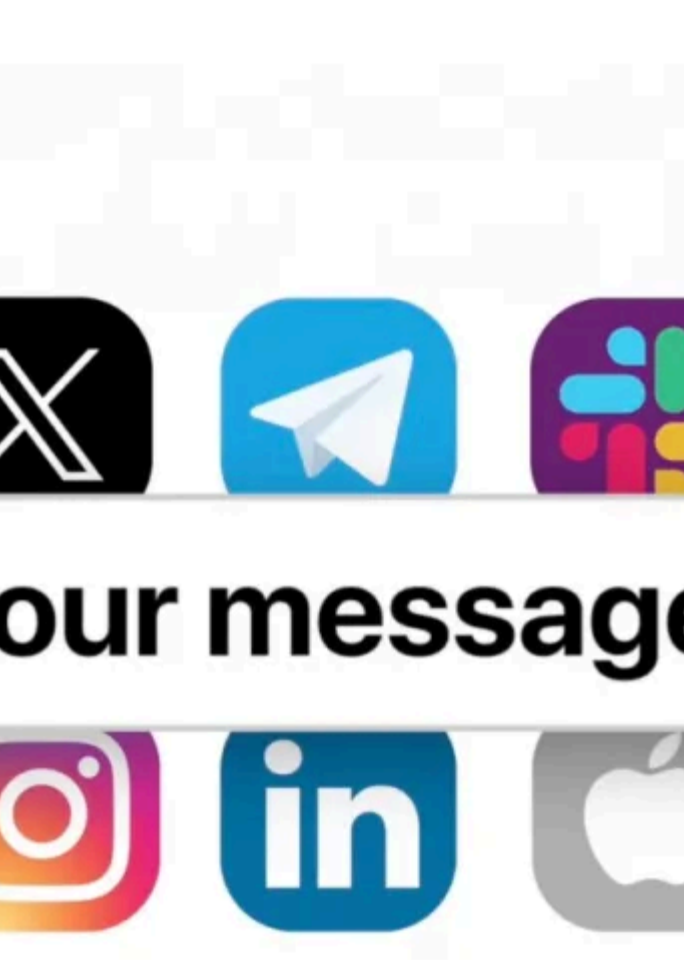
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APPS





WordPress.com owner buys all-in-one messaging app Texts.com for \$50M

Sarah Perez — 7:04 AM PDT · October 24, 2023

WordPress.com and Tumblr owner [Automattic](#) is adding another company to its portfolio with today's news that it has acquired the all-in-one messaging app [Texts.com](#) for \$50 million. The app brings all your messaging apps together in a single dashboard, including [iMessage](#), [Slack](#), [WhatsApp](#), [Instagram](#), [Telegram](#), [Messenger](#), [LinkedIn](#), [Signal](#), [Discord](#) and [X](#), with plans for more in the future, a [company blog post announced](#).

Though other companies have tried to do something similar — like [Beeper](#) — Texts.com offers end-to-end encryption of your chats and other features users have always wanted, like the ability to schedule messages at a time that's convenient for the recipient, not just for you. In addition, you can mark messages as unread even on services that don't offer that feature, allowing you to remember to check that message again when you return, as well as get summaries of long group chats you've missed.

The company explained its interest in the messaging platform in an [announcement](#), saying

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that the acquisition allows it to move into a “fourth market that’s integral to the modern web experience: messaging.”

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[The Verge](#) first reported the news of the acquisition.

Speaking to [the Pivot podcast](#), Automattic owner Matt Mullenweg explained that, in part, some of the desire for the deal was born out of personal frustration — everyone has multiple messaging apps, and it’s hard to track who you messaged on each one.

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"I found myself sort of getting very behind and so went out in the market and actually Automattic ended up making some investments in this space over the last few years, including in [Element, which is a Matrix company](#), [Beeper](#), which is another app, which has some similar things, but differently, and came across Texts, and was really just taken with the product," he explained.

In addition, he said he likes to work in areas that you can spend the rest of your life on.

But Mullenweg also pointed to the current regulatory framework as something that made the deal more viable. With the EU regulations, he believed that it would be more difficult for Apple, Google and Meta to block a smaller player like Texts because it's user-centric, runs client-side and is 100% encrypted.

"So it's just as secure as their desktop apps," he said. (Apple has fought against opening up its iOS platform to third-party app stores because they're less secure than its own. It couldn't make that same argument with Texts.com, apparently.)

According to Texts' website, messages are never sent to its own servers — they're sent directly to the platforms, which is how they're able to preserve

end-to-end encryption. In other words, they work just like the official apps do. Their servers also host no sensitive data, messages or account credentials, and all the data stays on your device.

Mullenweg also believes that putting a messaging app in the hands of a company like Automattic — a sizable company not considered a part of “Big Tech” — will allow it to develop Texts more quickly and maintain its focus. He suggested that big companies, like Google, often don’t get messaging right. (In fact, Google had [so many different messaging initiatives](#) at one point, it became a running joke.) Plus, iMessage has been locked into the Apple ecosystem, which excludes people from participating if they don’t have an iPhone or Mac. U.S. teens, in particular, are locked into the Apple universe because of the blue bubbles, [The Wall Street Journal reported last year](#).

The Automattic founder also said that Texts.com fits into the company because of its user-centric values tied to the way it tries to support everything people use for messaging.

“As users, we use all these things. And the companies want to pretend you don’t, but we all do. So that’s also something we’ve taken a big approach for...we just tried to integrate with everything. Open source also makes it easy, because people can write plug-ins for anything,” he said. “So I think if you keep those three things in mind, you can compete with the big guys, and in fact, thrive.”

Texts.com is [available](#) at \$15 per month for most users, or \$30 per month for businesses. It runs on Mac, Windows and Linux with apps for iOS and Android on the way. iMessage is only supported on Mac, and SMS only with iMessage. WhatsApp, Telegram, Signal, Messenger, Twitter, Instagram,

LinkedIn, IRC, Slack and Discord DMs are also offered.



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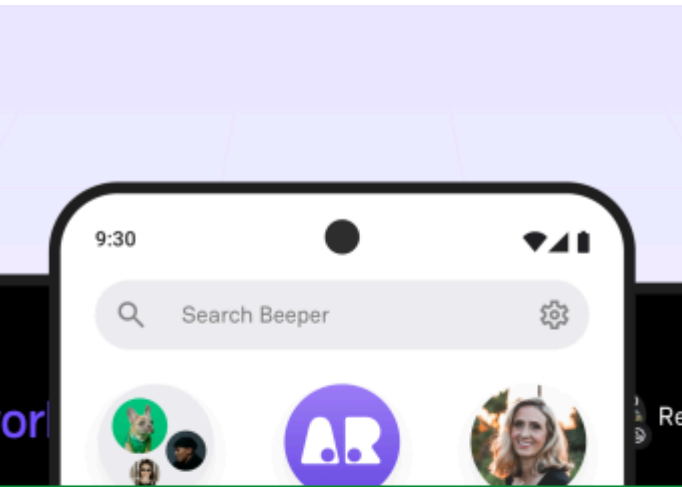


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WordPress.com owner Automattic acquires multiservice messaging app Beeper for \$125M

Sarah Perez — 7:49 AM PDT · April 9, 2024

IMAGE CREDITS: BEEPER

WordPress.com owner Automattic is acquiring [Beeper](#), the company behind [the iMessage-on-Android solution](#) that was [referenced by the Department of Justice](#) in its antitrust lawsuit against Apple. The deal, which was for \$125 million according to sources close to the matter, is Automattic's second acquisition of a cross-platform messaging solution after [buying Texts.com](#) last October.

That acquisition made Texts.com founder Kishan Bagaria Automattic's new head of Messaging, a role

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that will now be held by Beeper founder [Eric Migicovsky](#), previously the founder of the Pebble smartwatch and a Y Combinator partner.

Reached for comment, Automattic said it has started the process of onboarding the Beeper team and is “excited about the progress made” so far but couldn’t yet share more about its organizational updates, or what Bagaria’s new title would be. However, we’re told he is staying to work on Beeper as well.

IMAGE CREDITS: BEEPER

Beeper and Texts.com’s teams of 25 and 15, respectively, will join together to take the best of each company’s product and merge it into one platform, according to Migicovsky.

“[Texts.com] built an amazing app that’s more desktop-centric and iOS-centric,” he said. “So we’ll be folding the best parts of those into our app. But going forward, the Beeper brand will apply to all of the messaging efforts at Automattic,” he said, adding, “Kishan ... I’ve known him for years now — there’s not too many other people in the world that are doing what we do — and it was great to be able to combine forces with them.”

The deal, which closed on April 1, represents a big bet from Automattic: that the future of messaging will be open source and will work across services, instead of being tied up in proprietary platforms, like

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Meta's WhatsApp or Apple's iMessage. In fact, Migicovsky says, the eventual plan after shifting people to the Beeper cross-platform app for managing their messages is to move them to Beeper's own chat protocol — something based on the open source protocol called Matrix.

IMAGE CREDITS: BEEPER

Automattic had previously made a [strategic investment of \\$4.6 million](#) in [Element](#) ([previously New Vector](#)), another company building on Matrix, and it contributes annually to Matrix.org, as does Beeper.

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Matrix, a sort of “spiritual successor” to XMPP, as Migicovsky describes it, offers an open source, end-to-end encrypted client and server communications system, where servers can federate with one another, similar to open source Twitter/X alternative [Mastodon](#). However, instead of focusing on social networking, like Mastodon, it focuses on messaging.

Migicovsky said the acquisition came about because running Beeper costs quite a bit of money and it was either time to raise more funding or find a buyer. To date, Beeper had raised \$16 million in outside funding, including an \$8 million Series A from Initialized. Other investors include YC, Samsung Next, and Liquid2 Ventures, and angels Garry Tan, Kevin Mahaffey, and Niv Dror, and the group SV Angel.

“I’ve known Matt [Mullenweg, Automattic founder and CEO] for years now,” Migicovsky said, adding that the WordPress.com founder had shown commitment to open source technology, like Beeper, where about half its product is already open source. “We were looking to find a partner that could financially support this. One of the reasons why there are no other people building this type of app is it costs a surprisingly large amount of money to build a damn good chat app,” Migicovsky noted.

As for Beeper's products, the company has now briefed the DOJ on what happened when [Apple blocked its newer app](#), Beeper Mini, which aimed to bring iMessage to Android. That solution is [no longer being updated](#) as a result of Apple's moves.

IMAGE CREDITS: BEEPER

Beeper on Android launches to all

The company is instead releasing an updated version of [its core app, Beeper](#), on Android. Unlike Beeper Mini, which focuses only on iMessage, the main app connects with 14 services, including Messenger, WhatsApp, Telegram, Signal, Instagram DM, LinkedIn, Twitter/X, Discord, Google Messages and others. Android is its biggest platform by users, as 70% are on Google's smartphone OS.

In this rewritten version of Beeper, the company is starting to roll out fully end-to-end encrypted messages across Signal. That will be soon followed by WhatsApp, Messenger and Google Messages.

Because of Apple's restrictions, iMessage only works if you have an iPhone in the mix, Migicovsky says, and will not be a focus for Beeper, given the complications it saw with Apple's shutdown of Beeper Mini. However, Beeper is hopeful regulations could change things, pointing to the DOJ lawsuit and [FCC investigation](#). In the meantime,

Beeper supports [RCS](#), which solves iMessage to Android problems like low-res images and videos, lack of typing indicators and encryption.

With the launch out of beta, the new app includes a new icon, updated design, instant chat opens and sends, the ability to add and modify chat networks directly on Android (no desktop app needed), local caching of all chats on the device and full message search.

The 10,000 Android beta testers already on Beeper will need to download the new app manually from [Google Play](#) — it won't automatically update.

IMAGE CREDITS: BEEPER

In addition, the 466,000 or so people on Beeper's waitlist will now be able [to try the product](#). They'll join over 115,000 users who have already downloaded the app, which is now used by tens of thousands daily. The app runs on Android, iPhone, iPad, ChromeOS, macOS, Windows and Linux.

The team expects to have feature parity across platforms in a matter of months as they overhaul the iOS and desktop apps.

In time, they plan to add other services to Beeper as well, including Google Voice, Snapchat and Microsoft Teams. Beeper also offers a widget API so developers can build on top of Beeper. Plus, since

Matrix is an open standard, developers will be able to build alternative clients for Beeper, as well.

The app will generate revenue via a premium subscription, where the final price may be a couple of dollars per month, but pricing decisions haven't yet been fully nailed down. Beeper is currently free to use.

Like Automattic, Beeper's team is remotely distributed, with employees in Brazil, the U.K., Germany and the U.S. At present, Texts.com will continue to operate as the teams begin to integrate the two messaging apps.

[DOJ calls out Apple for breaking iMessage-on-Android solution, Beeper](#)

[FCC commissioner pushes to investigate Apple's decision to block Beeper Mini](#)

Updated 4/9/24, 5:05 PM ET to clarify that Beeper's chat protocol is based on Matrix.

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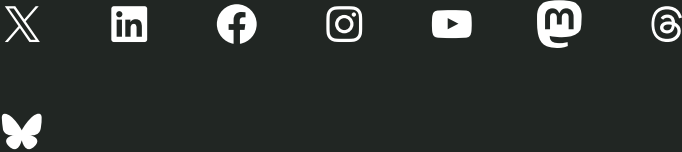
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